Indiana Economic Development Corp®

SSI PROGRAM

Indiana Strategic Sites Inventory (SSI) Program



Executive Team Briefing

November 10, 2026

Prepared by Location Design Group, LLC
(formerly Leotta Location and Design)

LOCATION Design Group

What Indiana already owns

1,811
greenfield sites, all 92 counties

235,402
acres

74
counties ranked in local workshops

490
sites ranked 4.0 or higher

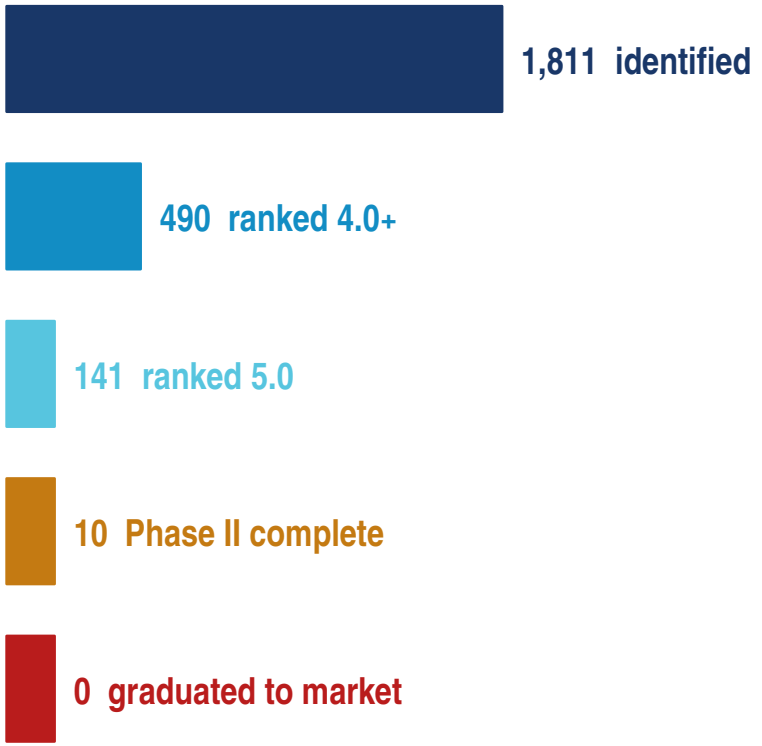
141
sites ranked 5.0

70
potential mega sites

$1.39M over seven years. $1.21M of it IEDC's, three agreements, six signatories, two administrations.

LEAP sits on an SSI-certified site by IEDC's own description. $23B+ announced there since 2022.

IDENTIFICATION TO GRADUATION



Identification without graduation is a map, not a product.

The market moved to site readiness

61%

of site selectors: development-ready site availability is the #1 elimination factor

+20 pts

one-year jump in the weight of readiness and due diligence status

27

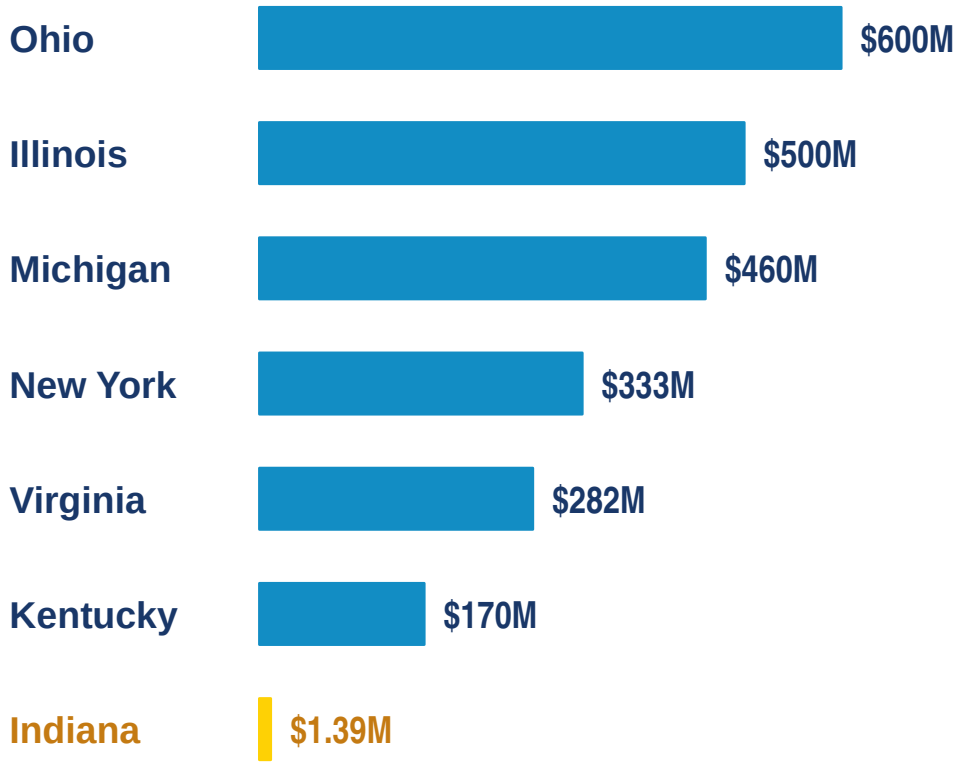
states now fund site readiness

<10

sites over 250 acres left in Virginia after $282M and a string of wins

Sources: Site Selectors Guild and DCI, March 2026; Area Development, 2026; Virginia Business, January 2024.

SITE READINESS FUNDING BY STATE SINCE 2022



Peer states pay to find and qualify sites. Indiana has paid for the finding. Graduation is the step not yet funded.

Indiana's policies and drivers: what the program answers

GOVERNOR'S OFFICE AND GENERAL ASSEMBLY

Region-led planning, EO 25-45
15 regions, each with a growth plan

Wage standard, EO 25-44
County average wage as the incentive floor

CIRDA and the $1B life sciences initiative
100,000 jobs at 125% of county wage

HEA 1406 redevelopment credits
$35M a year against a ranked development plan

IEDC

Sites that are held, ready, and marketable
REDOs lack the time and the playbook

Defense, life sciences, pharmaceuticals
Sector-specific site requirements

Data centers communities will accept
50+ counties restricting; large tracts absorbed

Lower-cost, targeted incentives
A controlled site is the cheapest incentive

Everyday RFI response and expansion
Portal, NAICS search, existing-business growth

Where the program stands

DONE

- All 92 counties searched twice
- 74 counties ranked in workshops
- Nine portals, 107 sub-licenses

STARTED

- Phase II on 10 sites, utility funded
- 24 sites nominated, unfunded
- Phase III method drafted, 2026 edition

NOT STARTED

- No site taken to a purchase option
- No NAICS-coded, Signals-ready inventory
- 18 counties never reviewed

PROGRAM CONDITIONS THAT DRIVE THE RESTART

SSI Phase I Updates

2018 to 2021 searches and rankings rescreened; sites lost, encroached, rezoned, or newly served

Keep the inventory whole

18 counties, refreshed ownership and zoning

SSI Portal licensing

Lapsed mid-2025; the system of record for RFI response

Phase III, drafted, never run

No Indiana site advanced under the method

Phase V and the national campaign

Site Profiles, NAICS brochures, Signals, SSI-Certified

The response: a three-year Site Graduation Program in eight tracks

	TRACK	SCOPE AND QUANTITY	DRIVER SERVED
A	**Complete and refresh the inventory**	18 workshops; Phase I Updates; 490 sites refreshed	Region-led planning; inventory whole
F	**Data center model for smaller sites**	25 to 150 acres on existing substation and fiber capacity	Data centers communities will accept
G	**Inactive Facility Revitalization for CIRDA**	Ten-county facility inventory, ranked	CIRDA; HEA 1406
H	**SSI: Community for CIRDA**	Areas of opportunity in distressed communities	CIRDA; HEA 1406
B	**Phase II preliminary due diligence**	36 sites, weighted to priority sectors	Target industries
C	**Phase III site advancement for the REDOs and LEDOs**	18 sites under purchase option; REDO training	Sites held, ready, marketable
D	**Target-industry technical marketing**	490 NAICS codings; 100 profile sets; Signals-ready	Target industries; Phase V
E	**SSI Portal and program management**	Licenses, RFI support, quarterly reporting	Everyday RFI response

Budget set in joint scoping at LDG unit rates. Cost share with the Power Partners on the NIPSCO 80/20 or 50/50 model. Procured competitively, with third-party due diligence and Audit and Finance review.

CIRDA Sites: the inventory as the Catalyze Plan's product

Catalyze needs competitive buildings and sites. SSI and IFRI provide the inventory. Branding and a county-by-county campaign turn it into product.

1

Pull and rescreen

Ten counties, 4.0+; 2021 rankings rescreened; Tipton's first workshop

2

Align by NAICS

Catalyze sectors: human, animal, plant health; advanced manufacturing; logistics

3

Map the ecosystem

Anchor campus, supplier park, logistics, R&D flex, facility reuse

4

Qualify and designate

Phase II, site control, zoning; CIRDA Sites standard; HEA 1406 sites

5

Ten county stories

Profile, brochure, StoryMap, and a narrative per county

6

Run the campaign

Sector outreach, Signals matching, co-branded releases, credits attached

Gives the plan its land and buildings

The piece a tax credit cannot buy

Feeds the HEA 1406 development plan

An objective, ranked list CIRDA can adopt

Reaches every member community

Ten counties, ten stories, one brand

Measurable in the state's terms

Sites, RFIs, projects, wages at 125%

A national marketing campaign built on the SSI Program

IEDC's 2023 release said Indiana leads the nation on strategic site identification. The claim has a 1,811-site, 92-county inventory behind it, and no other state can make it. A campaign converts that position into deal flow once sites graduate.

The SSI-Certified Site mark

A published standard: ranked 4.0 or higher, Phase II complete, under site control, zoning-aligned. Each graduation announced as a named, documented product.

Site selector and consultant outreach

Direct briefings to the consultants who report readiness as the number one elimination factor; Indiana's inventory presented as searchable, ranked, and controlled.

Sector campaigns

Defense, life sciences, pharmaceuticals, data centers, and agbioscience, each with NAICS-coded Site Profiles and brochures matched to the sector's requirements.

Demand matching with SSI: Signals

Expansion-intent intelligence matched to specific Indiana sites, so outreach goes to companies already moving, with the site attached.

Co-branded with the partners

Power Partners, 15 regions, and the counties carry one message; an annual SSI Program Day at the Speedway restores the convening IEDC ran in 2022.

An earned media cadence

LEAP as the precedent; graduation milestones, county wins, and Phase II completions released on a schedule, nationally and in trade press.

What IEDC gets: national positioning as the one state with a complete, ranked, and controlled greenfield inventory, message discipline across eight utilities and 15 regions, and a marketing product that grows by six graduated sites a year. Delivered under Phase V, Track D, and the program management track.

Priorities, in order of dependency

Immediate: first 60 days

- Renew the SSI Portal licenses
- Scope the eight tracks with IEDC and the Power Partners
- Respond to CIRDA's RFPQ
- Publish the Candidate Site Index; select year-one cohorts (12 Phase II, 6 Phase III)

Near-term: months 3 to 6

- Run the 18 outstanding county workshops
- Start year-one Phase II and Phase III
- CIRDA facility inventory and SSI: Community baseline
- Data center model for smaller sites
- Begin NAICS coding of the 490

6 to 12 months

- SSI Phase I Updates for the earliest counties
- First 35 profile sets; connect the portal to SSI: Signals
- First Phase III cohort to site control
- Frame the national campaign and the CIRDA Sites standard
- First quarterly report in IEDC's terms

First graduations within 12 to 15 months of restart. By year three: 18 graduated sites, 46 with Phase II, 490 coded and Signals-ready, all 92 counties ranked, the portal live.

Return on investment, and the cost of not continuing

Invest

- 18 sites graduated under purchase option, the first controlled cohort outside LEAP
- CIRDA facility and neighborhood inventories behind the $1B initiative and HEA 1406
- A small-site data center inventory communities will host
- 490 sites NAICS-coded and Signals-ready; 100 profile sets
- All 92 counties ranked; the portal live for IEDC, eight utilities, 107 organizations

Seven years of program cost less than one mid-size incentive package. Reported quarterly: jobs and wages at the 125% standard, incentive dollars per job against $16,014.

Do not continue

- The portal goes dark for IEDC, the utilities, and 107 local organizations
- Data from 2018 to 2021 decays; absorption unrechecked
- 18 counties stay invisible to RFI response
- Utilities and LEDOs reallocate; a restart becomes a rebuild
- Peer states convert inventories into product while Indiana's sits unadvanced

Rebuilding in 2029 costs more than the original, takes three to five years, and yields a weaker result. The head start is decisive for two to three years.

Four decisions, in order of priority

1

Authorize joint scoping

LDG and IEDC's site selection staff scope the eight tracks within 60 days; unit pricing from LDG; Power Partners invited to confirm cost share.

2

Renew the SSI Portal licenses now

IEDC, the LEDO and REDO network, and the utilities, so the system of record is up during scoping.

3

Support LDG's response to CIRDA's RFPQ

So the IFRI and SSI: Community tracks are scoped against the Catalyze Plan adopted in October 2026.

4

Schedule the briefing

The inventory, the LEAP precedent, and the lead generation work that will draw on it, at the President's convenience.

Indiana SSI Program 2.0

Site graduation to market while supporting key state initiatives and positioning REDOs and LEDOs with the real estate assets needed to attract industry targets.

Victor Leotta
Director, Strategic Sites
Location Design Group, LLC
(225) 281-4202
victor@location-design.com